

★ FREE CHECKLIST · THE AI CUT

Before You Hit Publish

22 checks for a SaaS product video

The checks I run before a product video leaves my hands. Skip one and it usually costs a re-render, a re-upload or an awkward email.

01 Message

03 Sound

05 Delivery

02 Screen & product

04 Captions & text

How to use it: open the PDF, tick each box as you go, save it with the project. If something can't be ticked, it goes back to the edit, not into “we'll fix it after launch”.

01

Message

Does it say one thing, clearly?

☐ **The first 3 seconds are about the viewer, not the product**

No logo intro, no “Introducing...”. Open on the friction.

☐ **The video is built around one idea**

Ask a colleague what it was about. One sentence back = pass.

☐ **Every feature shown supports that idea**

If a feature is there because someone asked nicely, cut it.

☐ **There is exactly one CTA, and it matches the goal**

Trial, demo or learn more. Not all three.

☐ **It still makes sense with the sound off**

Most feeds autoplay muted. Watch it once on mute.

02

Screen & product

Is what we show true and safe?

☐ **UI matches what ships on launch day**

Last-minute UI changes mean re-renders. Check the build, not the Figma file.

☐ **No real customer data, emails or names on screen**

Use demo accounts. Check every frame, including blurred backgrounds.

☐ **Claims and numbers are approved**

Stats, “fastest”, “#1”: someone owns each one.

☐ **Brand fonts, colors and logo usage are right**

Including the end card and the thumbnail.

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- ☐ **Voiceover is clean and consistently loud**
Around -14 LUFS integrated is a safe target for web and social.

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- ☐ **Music ducks under the voice**
No fighting for the same frequencies in the hook.

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- ☐ **Product names and acronyms are pronounced right**
Especially with AI voiceover. Fix with phonetic spelling.

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- ☐ **Music and SFX are licensed for commercial use**
Keep the license link in the project folder.
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- ☐ **Captions are proofread against the final edit**
Auto-captions get 90% right. The last 10% is your brand.
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- ☐ **Captions and text sit inside the safe zones**
Keep them clear of platform UI on 9:16 (top and bottom).
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- ☐ **On-screen text is on screen long enough to read twice**
Short callouts, max ~5 words each.
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- ☐ **Translated versions were checked by a native speaker**
Dubbing and subtitles both.
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- ☐ **Every format is exported and checked**
16:9, 9:16, 1:1 or 4:5. Re-framed, not just cropped.
- ☐ **There is a thumbnail or poster frame for each placement**
A paused frame mid-blink is not a thumbnail.
- ☐ **Files are named so nobody uploads the wrong one**
product_feature_16x9_v3_FINAL.mp4 is not a name.
- ☐ **Captions file (SRT/VTT) is attached where the platform allows**
Better for accessibility and search than burned-in only.
- ☐ **Someone watched the final export end to end on a phone**
Not the timeline. The actual file, on the actual device.

All 22 ticked?

Publish it. Then watch the first 48 hours of retention: the moment people drop off tells you more about the next video than any checklist.

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